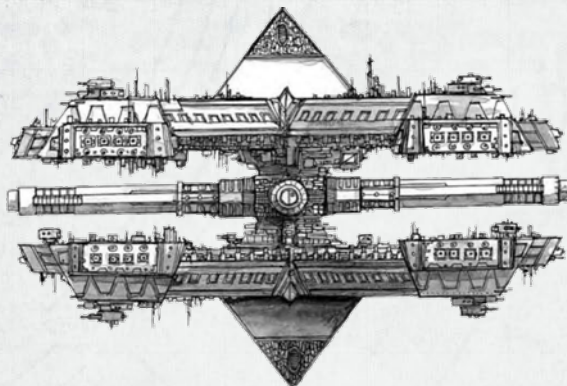




TYPE/HITS	SPEED	TURNS	SHIELDS	ARMOUR	TURRETS
Defence/16	0	0	6	5+	6
ARMAMENT		RANGE/SPEED		FIREPOWER/STR	
Weapons battery		60 cm		20	
Lance battery		60 cm		4	
Launch bays		Fighters: 30 cm Bombers: 20 cm		8 squadrons	
				–	

The mighty Blackstone Fortresses were the foundation of the Imperial Naval strategy and presence in the Gothic Sector. With the exception of Port Maw, each sub-sector was based upon the location of a Blackstone Fortress, which functioned as the primary naval base for the sub-sector. Although almost entirely dormant, a Blackstone Fortress was still open to exploitation by Imperial forces. The Adeptus Mechanicus linked numerous weapon systems to its alien and near-incomprehensible energy grid, opened up vast chambers to be used as attack craft launch bays and installed defence turrets over its surface. Thought impregnable by the Navy, the Blackstone Fortresses were finally overcome by Abaddon using a previously undiscovered method of shutting down the power supply, thus rendering all the weapons and defence turrets useless. Once deactivated, the Blackstone Fortresses were defenceless against ranged attacks and almost undefendable against a determined boarding action. At the end of the Gothic War, the Blackstone Fortresses still under Imperial control destroyed themselves; it is unknown whether those controlled by Abaddon suffered a similar fate.